Studio Report: University of Auckland

John Elmsly

School of Music,
University of Auckland
Private Bag 92019 Auckland
New Zealand

ja.elmsly@auckland.ac.nz

Abstract

Does electronic music study mean aesthetic stifling, reliance on standardised models of 'university' computer music? This report will place particular emphasis on the undergraduate teaching activities: details of goals and methodology of our new introductory course, Music and Technology, and the 200 and 300 level papers in electronic music which account for most of our teaching. Around forty students each year are involved at various levels of studio composition that has included music for theatre, dance, film and video, and interactive compositions. Students are a mix of music majors and others from Film Studies, Science, Fine Arts, Architecture and Engineering.

Approaches to teaching, attitudes to aesthetic boundaries in assignment work, and software currently used will be discussed, and the sort of creative skill that is manifesting itself even within the boundaries of 'the assignment' will be illustrated with selections from simple project work (over 4 weeks and mostly dealing with sequenced FM sounds) by the following 200 level and 300 level students:

Daniel Peach, ***Army Ants***; Ken Merrick, ***Hub Mind***; Lisa Kim, ***Pitch Black***; Matthew Brennan, ***Horror Master***; SooYoung Lee, ***Resurfacing***; Amie Ridley, ***Time Lapse Desert***; David Lindsay, ***Windshine*** ; Edward Pickmere, ***The Eerie Enchantment*** ; Ruth Campbell, ***Desert***; Roderick Skipp.